

◆ DECK · 46 CARDS

Two decks, **no Diamonds**. Keep 5 · 10 · J · Q · K · A · 2 + Jokers: six each of **10, J, Q, K, A, 2** · four plain 5s · two Heart 5s · two Big + two Small Jokers.

◆ CONTRACTS

listed low → high stakes

CONTRACT	IF DECLARED	WIN / LOSS
Quiet	No one declares. First bidder leads, first to shed out wins.	9
Breakaway	No added rules.	15 / 10
Forced Shovel	Declarer must hold a 10 to bid and shovel whenever able, playing 10s only in the final play. Must shovel at least once, or finish holding 10s.	18 / 12
Clean Hands	Declarer must never shovel. One shovel fails instantly.	24 / 16
Buried Treasure	Reveal the top 3 set-aside. Defender keeps 1 or 2, declarer takes the leftover.	27 / 18
Red Finish	Defender leads. Declarer’s final play must contain a Heart 5.	42 / 28
Blackout	Defender leads. Declarer must never lead a single (beating one is fine).	48 / 32
The Chase	Declarer takes the top 3 set-aside. Defender leads. Win before the defender drops below 3 cards on a turn. A shovel won’t trigger it.	54 / 36
Shutout	Declarer sheds out before the defender plays a single card.	96 / 64
Heavenly	A Shutout, but the defender gets one last chance to beat or shovel the final play.	108 / 72

Bid higher to stay in. A pass closes the auction. The last (highest) bidder is declarer. **Win** = declarer succeeds. **Loss** = opponent scores. Match to **150** or **250** points. Scorer also gets **+1 per card** left in opponent’s hand (capped at the contract score earned, no bonus for Shutout or Heavenly).

◆ SETUP

Deal **18** to each player. Set the other **10 aside face down**, unused except as noted by certain contracts. First bidder = fewer points (random on hand 1). In every declared contract, declarer aims **to shed out before the defender**, usually leads first, and fails if the defender sheds out first. The table lists only what each contract adds or changes.

◆ CARD RANK

high → low



Heart 5s stand apart: they pair only with each other, never with other 5s. **Jokers** play as singles or same-kind pairs only.

◆ LEGAL PLAYS

Single	One card.
Pair	Two of a rank. Heart 5s & same-kind Jokers may pair.
Set	Three to six of a kind.
Single Run	4 or 5 consecutive singles using 10 · J · Q · K · A only.
Connected Sets	3+ consecutive equal-size groups using 10 · J · Q · K · A only.

Match the **type and shape**, then play a higher rank. Runs and connected sets compare by their highest card or group. **No bombs, no cross-type beating**.

◆ SHOVEL · 10s

Play 10s **one fewer** than the opponent's current set to capture it into your hand.

10 →	a pair
10 · 10 →	a triple
10 · 10 · 10 →	a 4-of-a-kind
10 · 10 · 10 · 10 →	a 5-of-a-kind
10 · 10 · 10 · 10 · 10 →	a 6-of-a-kind

The 10s stay as the active play. Cannot capture **Heart 5s** or **Jokers**.